Abbey Healthcare – Document Archiving Automation Options

This document outlines two possible approaches to organising scanned archive documents within the existing SharePoint system. The objective is to simplify the process of finding HR, Resident and Administrative documents that are currently being scanned from historical archive boxes.

Current Situation

- Documents are scanned using PaperCut and sent to a SharePoint archive folder.
- Files arrive with scanner-generated names that make them difficult to identify later.
- Archive boxes contain mixed document types (HR, Resident, Admin etc).
- Records must be retained for at least six years.
- Staff need a quick and reliable way to locate documents in the future.

Proposed Folder Structure

A clear structure within SharePoint would make searching significantly easier.

```
Archive
  ├── Residents
  |     ├── Care Home Name
  |         ├── Resident Name
  ├── HR
  |     ├── Contracts
  |     ├── Disciplinary
  |     ├── Staff Records
  ├── Admin
  |     ├── Invoices
  |     ├── Compliance
  |     ├── General Administration
  └── Archive Inbox (all scanned documents arrive here first)
```

Option 1 – Automated Filing (Without AI)

In this option, scanned documents arrive in the 'Archive Inbox' folder. A Power Automate workflow monitors the folder and moves documents to the correct location based on a simple naming convention.

Example file naming format:
HR_contract_john_smith_2021.pdf
RES_careplan_mary_jones.pdf
ADM_invoice_supplier.pdf

Power Automate reads the prefix and automatically files the document into the appropriate folder (HR, Residents or Admin).

Advantages

- Simple to implement
- Very low monthly cost
- Works with existing scanning process
- Suitable for initial archive digitisation

Limitations

- Documents must be renamed manually
- Staff must identify document type before filing
- Automation is limited to naming rules

Estimated Cost

Power Automate Premium License (1 account): approximately £11.50 per month.

Only the archive automation account would require the license. Staff scanning documents do not require individual licenses.

Option 2 – Intelligent Filing (With AI)

In this option, scanned documents are automatically analysed using AI. The system reads the contents of the document and determines whether it belongs to HR, Resident records or Administration.

The automation then:

- Renames the file
- Identifies document type
- Moves it to the correct SharePoint folder

Advantages

- Minimal manual input required
- Handles mixed archive boxes automatically
- Faster processing of large document volumes
- More advanced search capability

Limitations

- Slightly more configuration required initially
- Very large document volumes may require additional AI capacity

Estimated Cost

Power Automate Premium License (1 account): approximately £11.50 per month.
AI Builder credits are included with the license for moderate document volumes.

Licensing Summary

Recommended setup:
Automation runs under a single archive account (e.g. archive@abbeyhealthcare.org.uk).

Only one Power Automate license is required for the automation.
Staff scanning documents from care homes do not require additional licenses.

Summary

Both options would significantly improve the organisation of archived documents within SharePoint.

Option 1 provides a low-cost structured filing system suitable for initial digitisation of historical records.

Option 2 introduces AI-based automation that can automatically classify and file documents with minimal manual input.